

Sony unveils 3D laptops

Sony upgrades all-in-one VAIO L Series; now has full HD 3D 24-inch LED touchscreen, a 3D Blu-ray optical drive, PlayStation 3 connectivity, and 3D shutter

Fastest computer in the world

For the first time since 2004, a supercomputer built in Japan can claim to be the fastest on earth

Bazaar

HTC Desire S

Truly desirable? Maybe not.

The Desire S is a ₹28,900 phone riddled with contradictions. It's got the most top notch hardware and software combinations available when it comes to single core Androids, packing in the new generation 1GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon MSM 8255 SoC and Android 2.3.3 (Gingerbread) with HTC's Sense UI. But at the same time falters at its core function - being a phone.

At locations with low network availability, the phone seems to have trouble with switching towers to hunt for whichever signal is stronger. While there are no drops when on call at such locations, often you find no network on the phone when it had

been lying idle for a while. Searching for networks and registering manually solves the problem, still it's something we'd rather do without in a phone of this calibre. To add to this the speaker on the Desire S is abysmally soft. So be prepared to be greeted with a string of missed calls if the phone is kept away from you; even the TV is loud enough to drown out the little pipsqueak.

Apart from these flaws, we have good things to report from our tests, but we doubt whether you'd really care after the above revelations. The phone feels quite well built thanks to the aluminium unibody design. With its smooth curves and selective



usage of chrome, its easy on the eyes too. The battery lasts a day with mixed usage of data over 3G and Wi-Fi and about an hour of voice. The camera and screen are decent. To conclude, while the specs sheet reads like the A-list of single core Androids and on paper looks it like the best value proposition, it would probably be better to look at its elder sibling the Incredible S, which is devoid of these flaws.

Siddharth Parwatay

Specifications

CPU: 1 GHz; **Internal phone storage:** 1.1 GB
RAM: 768 MB; **Main Camera:** 5 MP autofocus with LED flash
Sensors: G, Proximity, Light, Compass; **Battery:** 1450 mAh L-ion
SoC: Qualcomm MSM8255
Misc: GPS, Wi-Fi b/g/n

Contact

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Web site: www.htc.com/in

Price: ₹28,900

6.0/10

Features..... 7.0
Performance..... 6.0
Build Quality 8.0
Value for money 6.0

Specifications

Screen: 13.3-inch, LED-backlit, 1366x768 res; **CPU:** Intel Core i5-2410M 2.3-GHz;
RAM: 4GB DDR3; **HDD:** 320GB; **GPU:** AMD Radeon HD 6470M (512MB) & Intel HD 3000; **OS:** Windows 7 Home Premium 64-bit

Contact

Sony India Pvt. Ltd.

Email: sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com

Web site: www.sony.co.in

Price: ₹56,990

8.0/10

Features..... 8.0
Performance..... 8.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for Money 7.5

Sony VAIO S (VPCSB16FG)

Balances portability and performance

The Sony VAIO S is a premium sleek performance-rich laptop, aimed at the style-conscious. The under 2kg laptop has a dull metal exterior with a fine sandpaper finish. Its keyboard deck is comprised of a single aluminium slab which dips and flexes if pressed heavily. The screen vibrates a bit while typing in a hurry, and it isn't exactly rugged.

In terms of features, the Sony VAIO S is better decked out than any other portable 13-inch notebook at its price. It has a quickfire CPU & GPU combo which elevates

it over most mainstream laptops. All its connectivity ports are situated on the right. There are HDMI and USB 3.0 ports. It also has a fingerprint sensor for biometric protection.

The VAIO S performs well overall. Despite having a spinning 5400-rpm drive, the laptop is extremely quick to boot into Windows 7 - consistently under 30 sec. Our benchmark

scores suggest a better than mid-range performance, overall, given its hardware configuration. Casual gamers will be happy to note the notebook handles games well at medium settings - anything more is a stretch. Typing on the back-lit isolated keys is great, so is the wide, smooth touchpad. Its six-cell battery lasted for 2 hours 20 minutes (on high performance mode) while looping a video. If you switch to the laptop's Stamina mode (onboard graphics), on a conservative battery plan, expect the battery to last more. Overall, a very good laptop for the price.

Jayesh Shinde

